B1 Vocabulary

Adjectives for feelings

Twelve adjectives to describe how you feel, plus the -ed and -ing difference that catches many learners.

Using exact feeling words makes your English sound natural and helps people understand you. Many of these adjectives have two forms: *-ed* for how a person feels and *-ing* for the thing that causes the feeling.

bored / boring adjective

feeling that nothing is interesting / not interesting

I was bored because the film was boring.

excited / exciting adjective

very happy and full of energy about something

The children are excited about the trip.

worried adjective

thinking that something bad may happen

She's worried about her exam.

upset adjective

unhappy because something bad happened

He was upset when he lost his phone.

embarrassed adjective

feeling silly or ashamed in front of others

I was embarrassed when I forgot her name.

relieved adjective

happy because a worry has gone

We were relieved to hear the flight was safe.

disappointed adjective

sad because something was not as good as you hoped

I was disappointed with my score.

confused adjective

not able to understand

The instructions made me confused.

proud adjective

pleased about something you or someone close did

My parents are proud of me.

nervous adjective

a little afraid before something important

I always feel nervous before interviews.

grateful adjective

wanting to thank someone

I'm grateful for your help.

homesick adjective

sad because you are away from home

She felt homesick during her first month abroad.

Common mistake. *I am boring* means you make other people bored. To describe your feeling, say *I am bored*.

Practice

1. The lesson was so ___ that I nearly fell asleep. (bored / boring)
2. I passed my driving test! I'm so ___ .
3. She forgot her lines on stage and felt very ___ .

4. We were ___ when the doctor said it was nothing serious.
5. He's ___ about the job interview tomorrow.
6. I'm really ___ for everything you've done for me.

▼ **Show answers**

1. boring
2. excited / proud
3. embarrassed
4. relieved
5. nervous / worried
6. grateful